



LEGAL TECHNOLOGY · ENTERPRISE UX

Legal Collaboration Platform at Thomson Reuters HighQ

Designing and optimising workflows for a B2B legal collaboration platform used by law firms and financial institutions.

ROLE

Senior Product Designer

TIMELINE

Nov 2013 – Mar 2021

INDUSTRY

Legal Technology

01

Context

HighQ, later acquired by Thomson Reuters, built cloud-based collaboration and content tools – including Collaborate, Publisher and Data Room – used by law firms, banks and corporates for document-heavy, high-stakes work. Over seven years, the product scaled from a single collaboration platform to a suite spanning dashboards, workflow, document automation and mobile apps.

02

The Challenge

Legal and financial workflows are domain-heavy by nature, and translating them into interfaces that non-specialist users could pick up quickly, without stripping out the capability specialists relied on, was a recurring challenge across every feature area.

03

Research

Led discovery and design thinking workshops with stakeholders to uncover client pain points, and introduced structured usability testing protocols to bring direct user evidence into design decisions that had previously relied on internal opinion.

Discovery workshops

Design thinking sessions

Usability testing

Functional & UI QA

04

Insights

The key findings that shaped the direction.

01

Domain complexity needed translation, not removal

Law firms and financial institutions needed the underlying capability preserved – the job was to make the workflow legible, not to simplify away what specialists actually relied on.

02

Usability testing changed how decisions got made

Once structured usability testing protocols existed, design decisions could be backed by direct user evidence instead of internal debate.

03

Mentoring scaled the design function further than headcount did

Cross-team mentoring initiatives let a relatively small design function support feature pods and delivery teams well beyond what direct staffing allowed.

05

Design Strategy

How decisions were made.

01

Shape strategic direction

Helped shape product direction toward simplicity, intuitiveness and consistency across a wide array of devices and platforms, working closely with the Chief Product Officer and later the VP of Product.

02

Translate domain complexity

Turned dense legal and financial workflows into interfaces, dashboards and data visualisations that reduced onboarding time for new users.

03

Test with real evidence

Introduced structured usability testing protocols and a shared design library, replacing opinion-led decisions with direct user evidence.

04

Scale through mentoring

Led cross-team mentoring initiatives, supporting designers across feature pods and delivery teams as the product suite grew.

06

Solution

A design system and structured usability testing practice applied across HighQ's growing suite – Collaborate, Publisher, Data Room, dashboards, workflow and mobile – translating domain-heavy legal and financial work into intuitive, consistent interfaces.

- ✓ Unified dashboards, data visualisations and workflow tools designed across the product suite
- ✓ Structured usability testing protocols bringing direct user evidence into design decisions

- ✓ iOS and Android HighQ Drive apps extending the platform to mobile

07

Design System Thinking

This project wasn't designed as a one-off — here's how it connects back to the system.



Components

A design library spanning Collaborate, Publisher, Data Room, dashboards and workflow tools, reused across feature pods.



Tokens

Consistent visual foundations applied across web and the HighQ Drive mobile apps on iOS and Android.



Patterns

Patterns for translating dense legal and financial workflows into intuitive dashboards and data visualisations.



Governance

Cross-team mentoring and design QA at the close of every sprint, using JIRA to track functional and UI testing.

08

Impact

Onboarding time and support volume both reduced as domain-heavy workflows became easier to learn, and the structured usability testing practice introduced during this period gave the design function a lasting evidence base for future decisions.

7+

Years on the platform

**iOS &
Android**

HighQ Drive mobile apps

Reduced

Onboarding time &
support volume

09

Reflection

Seven years on one product is long enough to watch a design function grow up. The shift that mattered most wasn't a single feature — it was moving from opinion-led decisions to a usability testing practice with real evidence behind it, and then scaling that judgement through mentoring rather than headcount alone.